IBM is committed to skill **30 million people globally by 2030**, and as part of this larger goal, IBM aims to skill **2 million people in AI by 2026**

The future job market needs reskilling

Reskilling Needs

39%

of workers' existing skill sets will be transformed or become outdated over the 2025-2030 period*

New Opportunities

87%

of executives expect jobs to be augmented rather than replaced by gen AI**

On the Job Learning

85%

of employers plan to prioritize upskilling their workforce*

Skills Gap

47%

of executives say their people lack the knowledge and skills to effectively implement and scale AI across the enterprise**

*World Economic Forum: 2025 Future of Jobs Report
** IBV Study: 5 Trends for 2025

IBM commits to skill 5 million Indian youth in AI, Cybersecurity & Quantum by 2030

IBM

"India possesses the talent and ambition to lead the world in AI & Quantum. Fluency in frontier technologies will define economic competitiveness, scientific progress and societal transformation.

Our commitment to skill five million people is an investment in that future. By democratizing access to advanced skills, we are enabling the youth and students to build, innovate and accelerate India's growth."

Arvind Krishna,
Chairman and CEO, IBM

IBM

About the program

IBM SkillsBuild® is a free education program aimed at increasing access to technology education. Through the program, we support adult learners, and high school and university students and faculty, to develop valuable new skills and access career opportunities.

The program includes an online platform that is complemented by customized practical learning experiences delivered in collaboration with a global network of partners.

We support learners and instructors across ages and stages of their learning journey ↷

High school learners, teachers
Technology and human-centric workplace learning options for high school students and teachers to build foundational skills to prepare for the future of work

Academia learners, faculty
Access to technology, supporting research, learning materials and courses to advance relevant skills for today's workforce

Adult learners
Empowering professionals, already in the labor market, to become better qualified and secure jobs in the technology sector and beyond

Our offering to universities

Empowering students and faculty to thrive in an AI-driven world by providing accessible learning pathways and collaborative experiences that build AI and other tech competencies

Available now for students and faculty

Access to online courses

- On in-demand skills such as generative AI and cloud
- Available in short-form (in one hour or less to complete), long-form (hours/days to complete), and guided learning experiences
- Flexible implementation models

Hands-on labs
Join IBM experts to dig deeper on AI with interactive learning experiences using IBM technologies

Virtual events
Students can join IBM SkillsBuild events held by IBM experts

Available to selected universities*

In addition to what is already available to students and faculty, select universities can access:

Capstone projects
With IBM watsonx™ access, students can build real-world solutions over the course of a semester

Group innovation challenges
Students can join their peers for challenges to showcase their skills for portfolio work

Faculty training
AI training and resources that can help faculty cultivate their students' abilities

*Universities can connect with a local CSR manager for more information

Access to online courses

Expanded catalog of AI coursework coming soon!

Artificial Intelligence

Learners can gain foundational skills in generative AI, machine learning and cognitive computing.

Course examples:
- Machine learning and deep learning
- Introduction to large language models
- Build your first chatbot using IBM watsonx
- Summarizing data using IBM Granite

Cybersecurity

Learners can acquire core skills for threat intelligence, including network security and incident response.

Course examples:
- Introduction to cybersecurity
- Protecting a device with Malwarebytes
- Getting started with threat intelligence and hunting
- Enterprise security in practice

Data Analytics

Learners can apply analytic tools to analyze data, predict outcomes and visualize the results professionally.

Course examples:
- Data science landscape
- Overview of data tools and languages
- Enterprise data science in practice
- Machine learning for data science projects

Cloud

Learners can demonstrate how cloud services work, how to build a cloud solution, and transform it for business use cases.

Course examples:
- Understanding cloud deployment models
- Journey to cloud: Envisioning your solution
- Journey to cloud: Orchestrating your solution
- Journey to cloud: Transforming your culture

IBM SkillsBuild provides a wide range of courses in other areas, including project management, user experience design, web development, and more.

Virtual events

Our **virtual events** are interactive, online sessions designed to supplement your students' academic journey.

- **Deep-dive into courses and tech hot topics:** Get hands-on experience with IBM SkillsBuild courses, exploring topics in AI, cloud, data science, and more
- **Hear from industry experts:** Engage with IBM experts and thought leaders who share insights on the latest trends and innovations
- **Network with peers:** Attendees can connect with fellow students from around the world

Group innovation challenges

Available to selected universities

Students from participating universities can join **group innovation challenges**, a unique opportunity for aspiring developers to harness the power of cutting-edge technologies.

These short-term experiences are designed to foster creativity, innovation, and skill-building among students, while promoting collaboration and problem-solving.

Key highlights:

- **Hands-on experience with generative AI:** Participants will work with IBM watsonx, our portfolio of AI products, and IBM Granite, our family of open, performant, and trusted AI models
- **Real-world problem-solving:** Challenges will be designed to tackle real-world problems, allowing students to apply theoretical knowledge to practical scenarios
- **Collaborative environment:** Students will work in groups, promoting teamwork, communication, and creative problem-solving
- **Mentorship and support:** Our team will provide guidance and support throughout the challenge, ensuring students get the most out of the experience

Key differentiators

IBM SkillsBuild offers a distinct approach to skills development, with three key benefits that give students and faculty a competitive edge →

Digital credentials
By earning digital credentials, students can showcase their skills and abilities to potential employers

IBM technologies
Hands-on learning with IBM's latest technologies and tools helps students develop practical expertise

IBM expertise
Mentorship and guidance from experienced IBM professionals provide valuable industry insights and support

Digital credentials

Digital credentials are an industry standard for skills—a modern approach to translating knowledge into a portable and everyday language that benefits employers and learners:

Benefits for the employers (hiring organizations)

- Expand talent pool
- Skills validation
- Better matching between candidates and job positions
- Understand competencies and learning agility of the applicants

Benefits for learners

- Portability
- Security
- Increased visibility

*Application courses are only available to users associated with certain programs within IBM SkillsBuild partner organizations.

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In IBM SkillsBuild, the digital credentials are split by skills levels, ensuring significant skill achievement tied to resume-worthy activities:

1. Awareness

- General knowledge and fundamental competencies
- Technical skills

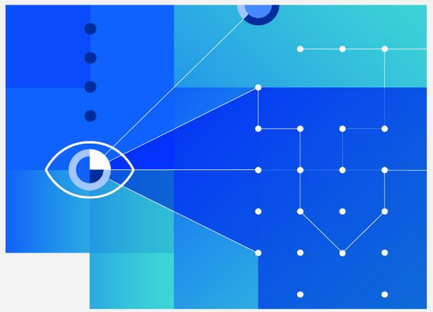
2. Comprehension

- Extended knowledge and competencies
- Technical skills

3. Application*

Proficiency and experience in applying a skill in a real-life environment (on the job, project, capstone)

IBM technologies



IBM Granite

Now in its third-generation, these **open-source AI language models** can enable students and faculty to explore innovative projects in areas like cybersecurity, research, and more, delivering exceptional performance and safety.

IBM watsonx*

IBM watsonx is a **cutting-edge suite of AI tools** that can accelerate the impact of generative AI, driving productivity and innovation for students and faculty alike. Watsonx can help enhance student learning experiences, optimize projects, and foster innovation.

*Available to select universities

IBM experts

IBM’s network of innovators and tech leaders support students on their journey from education to employment.

- Mentorship from IBM subject matter experts
- Guest lectures offer insights and industry perspectives
- Forums to exchange best practices and learn from IBM experts
- Online learning with technical content and hands-on labs

*Available to select universities

Partner with us

Explore the open platform and connect with us for a demo at skillsbuild.org

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Building CSR Ecosystem Partnerships to Advance Societal Benefit

Goal: At IBM India, we are strengthening IBM's network of **ecosystem collaborators** that simultaneously drive impact through effective Government partnerships, and establish IBM's AI Leadership.

Government & Academia Co-Labs

- Engaging with key government stakeholders — including the **Ministries of Education, Skill Development, and Electronics & IT; NITI Aayog; AICTE; CBSE and India.Ai** as well as and state skill missions in Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Uttarakhand etc — to ensure visibility and strengthen IBM's impact presence
- **New initiatives -** An AI Lab is being established at AICTE HQ as a hub for curriculum, research, and outreach. More of such Labs are planned in coming years.
- **Thought Leadership** – In partnership with Niti Aayog, IBM India is undertaking a study on the AI skilling landscape in the country that would inform academicians and policy makers to take required steps for innovation & planning.
- **University Education** is a key focus - Hackathons are being organized across engineering colleges, enabling students to develop innovative AI-driven solutions addressing real-world challenges in healthcare, cybersecurity, and financial inclusion.

Client/Partner- CSR Co-creation

- Launched IBM SkillsBuild across **Indian Air Force schools** and for **Air Force veterans**, expanding digital learning access and employability pathways.
- Partnered with **Amul** in seven Gujarat districts to deliver AI and digital skilling for women and youth, strengthening rural livelihoods through technology.
- Collaborating with the **Tech Mahindra Foundation** to make IBM SkillsBuild courses available nationwide via SMART Centers, extending reach to underserved learners.
- Joined forces with **NASSCOM** and **Capgemini** to skill 6,000 youth over 2.5 years through job-linked learning, virtual internships, and hackathons — reinforcing IBM's role in building India's future workforce.
- Trained faculty at an **Aditya Birla Foundation**–supported school on future skills, enhancing teacher readiness for the digital economy.
- Conducting university student hackathon in partnership with **AWS**, leveraging IBM's unique Gen AI university content for building industry talent pipeline

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS | Digital India Power To Empower | Skill India कौशल भारत - कुशल भारत | NITI Aayog | INDIAai A MEITY, NEGD & NASSCOM INITIATIVE | AICTE | National Education Policy 2020 | भारत सरकार GOVERNMENT OF INDIA PM Internship Scheme